

INTERNATIONAL news

ByteDance to invest \$7 billion in Nvidia AI chips

ByteDance, the parent company of TikTok, plans to invest \$7 billion in Nvidia's AI chips in 2025 to enhance its AI capabilities, despite US export restrictions on high-performance semiconductors. The investment is a part of ByteDance's strategy to become one of the largest consumers of Nvidia's chips, navigating geopolitical tensions and US measures to limit China's technological advancements, particularly in AI.

US funds \$5 billion for Samsung and \$407 million for Amkor's semiconductor facilities

The US government has confirmed nearly \$5 billion in funding for Samsung's semiconductor plants in Texas and \$407 million for Amkor's packaging facility in Arizona, supporting advanced technology and job creation. Samsung has an upcoming \$37 billion investment in Texas that will generate 12,000 construction and 3500 manufacturing jobs, while Amkor's project will create 2000 jobs.

Micron announces \$2.17 billion expansion in Virginia, US

Micron Technology has announced a \$2.17 billion investment to expand its semiconductor facility in Manassas, Virginia, boosting DRAM production. The expansion will create 340 new jobs and help meet increasing demand in sectors like automotive and aerospace. This investment is part of Micron's broader \$3 billion plan by 2030, supported by federal and state funding through the CHIPS Act.

Foxconn surpasses expectations with record 4Q24 revenue

Foxconn posted a groundbreaking Q4 revenue of NT\$2.132 trillion, driven by soaring demand for AI servers, marking a 15% YoY increase. Despite economic uncertainties, the company expects continued growth in 2025, with strong demand for AI servers, new computing products, and cloud infrastructure. Foxconn is also diversifying into electric vehicles and robotics.

EU invests in Spain's synthetic diamond factory

The European Commission has approved 81-million euro investment for a synthetic diamond factory in Trujillo, Spain, to strengthen the EU's semiconductor supply chain. The facility, part of a 675-million euro investment, will produce synthetic diamond wafers, offering better thermal conductivity and efficiency than silicon. This move supports the EU's digital and green transition, creating 300 jobs and boosting regional development.

Xerox seals \$1.5 billion deal for Lexmark, eyes better market share

Xerox has announced a \$1.5 billion deal to acquire Lexmark International from its Chinese owners, returning Lexmark to US ownership. The acquisition aims to strengthen Xerox's core business, enhance its competitiveness against HP and Canon, and expand in the Asia-Pacific region. The deal, expected to close in 2025, will reduce Xerox's dividend to reduce debt.

Taiwan's GlobalWafers gets \$406 million to boost US chip manufacturing

The US Commerce Department has granted \$406 million to Taiwan's GlobalWafers to support its \$4 billion investment in wafer plants in Texas and Missouri. This expansion will create 2500 jobs and enable the production of 300mm wafers for advanced

semiconductors, including chips for defence and aerospace. This funding is part of the CHIPS Act to boost US domestic chip manufacturing.

US awards \$225 million to Bosch for automotive SiC chip production

The US government will provide Bosch with up to \$225 million under the CHIPS and Science Act to enhance semiconductor manufacturing, especially for the automotive sector. Bosch will use the funding to expand its Roseville, California facility, focusing on SiC semiconductors for electric vehicles and other automotive technologies. The project aims to create up to 1700 jobs and strengthen the US supply chains.

Apple Teams with Broadcom to develop AI server chip

Apple is collaborating with Broadcom to develop its first AI server chip, code-named Baltra, set for mass production by 2026. The chip will be made using TSMC's advanced N3P process, offering improved energy efficiency and computational performance for AI applications. Reducing reliance on Nvidia's processors, Apple needs to strengthen its chip development to optimise hardware and software integration.

Renesas and Honda collaborate on cutting-edge SoC for software-defined vehicles

Honda and Renesas have partnered to develop a high-performance system-on-chip (SoC) for software-defined vehicles (SDVs). Unveiled at CES 2025, US, the SoC will offer 2000 TOPS AI performance with 20 TOPS/W power efficiency. It will power Honda's upcoming 'Honda 0 Series' electric vehicles, consolidating multiple ECUs into one, enabling advanced driver assistance, automated driving, and powertrain functions.

South Korea plans to setup KSMC to grow the chip ecosystem

South Korea plans to establish a state-funded contract chip-maker, tentatively named Korea Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (KSMC), following the TSMC model to boost the country's semiconductor industry. Ahn Ki-hyun of the Semiconductor Industry Association estimated that investing KRW 20 trillion (\$13.9 billion) in KSMC could yield KRW 300 trillion (\$208.7 billion) by 2045.

Tata Consulting Engineers acquires CDI, boosting US presence

Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE) has acquired US-based CDI Engineering Solutions to expand its presence in North America, targeting sectors like semiconductors and battery manufacturing. The acquisition grants TCE access to CDI's eight engineering centres and energy, chemicals, and emerging technologies expertise. This strategic move addresses global decarbonisation and infrastructure challenges, enhancing TCE's competitive edge.

Nexperia parent Wingtech sells off electronics division

Wingtech, the Chinese parent of Nexperia, plans to sell half of its business, including its product integration division, to refocus on semiconductor production. This move follows its inclusion on the US entity list, which targets firms aiding China's chip technology acquisition. Wingtech aims to strengthen its semiconductor capabilities amidst rising geopolitical tensions, with Luxshare Ltd set to acquire the assets.